Table 23.1 Drugs derived from Medicinal plants

S. No.	Tamil Name	Botanical Name	Drug	Parts used	Disease cured
1	Katrazhai	*Aloe vera*	Anthraquinones	Leaves	Heal wounds, Skin disease, Cancer, Psoriasis
2	Tulsi	*Ocimum sanctum*	Essential oil	Leaves	Cold, Fever, Skin disease
3	Nannari	*Hemidesmus indicus*	Terpene	Roots	Bacterial infections, Diarrhoea
4	Nilavembu	*Andrographis paniculata*	Terpenoids	All parts	Dengue fever, Diabetes, Chikungunya
5	Vetpalai	*Wrightia tinctoria*	Flavonoids	Latex, Leaves	Psoriasis, Diarrhoea, Swellings
6	Cinchona maram	*Cinchona officinalis*	Quinine	Bark	Malaria, Pneumonia
7	Chivan Amalpodi (Sarpagandha)	*Rauwolfia serpentina*	Reserpine	Root	Blood pressure, Antidote for Snake bite
8	Thaila maram	*Eucalyptus globulus*	Essential oil	Leaves	Fever, Headache
9	Pappali	*Carica papaya*	Papain	Leaf, Seed	Dengue
10	Nithya kalyani	*Catharanthus roseus*	Alkaloids	All parts	Leukemia, Cancer

Info bits

The Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR) and National Botanical Research Institute (NBRI) and Central Institute for Medicinal and Aromatic Plants (CIMAP) have jointly launched India's first anti diabetic ayurvedic drug **BGR -34** (BGR-Blood Glucose Regulator). It contains 34 identified active phytoconstituents from herbal resources. It works by controlling blood sugar levels.

23.5 Mushroom Cultivation

Mushroom cultivation is a technology of growing mushrooms using plant, animal and industrial waste. In short it is wealth out of waste technology. This technology has gained importance worldwide because of its dietary fibres and protein value. Mushroom is a fungi belonging to basidiomycetes. It is rich in proteins, fibres, vitamins and minerals. There are more than 3000 types of mushrooms. e.g. Button mushroom (Agaricus bisporus), Oyster mushroom (Pleurotus sps.), Paddy straw mushroom (Volvariella volvacea). The cultivation takes one to three months. Major stages of mushroom cultivation are explained below.

Composting: Compost is prepared by mixing paddy straw with number of organic materials like cow dung and inorganic fertilizers. It is kept at about 50 °C for one week.

Spawning: Spawn is the mushroom seed. It is prepared by growing fungal mycelium in grains under sterile conditions. Spawn is sown on compost.

Casing: Compost is covered with a thin layer of soil. It gives support to the growing mushroom, provides humidity and helps regulate the temperature.

Pinning: Mycelium starts to form little bud, which will develop into mushroom. It is known as pinning.Those little white buds are called pins.

Harvesting: Mushroom grow better in 15°C - 23°C. They grow 3 cm in a week which is the normal size for harvesting. In the third week the first flush mushroom can be harvested.



Fig 23.11 Mushrooms

Preservation: Discolouration, weight and flavour loss are the main problems during harvesting of

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